Team number: 7
Meeting date: April 28th

Summary of feedback on UI (record all pages that need revision)

The UI feedback primarily focused on improving layout consistency, spacing, responsiveness, and visual polish across multiple pages. On the home page, category boxes were considered too large for short labels, creating excessive dead space, and categories should be more compact and mobile-friendly. A footer is currently missing and should be added. The top banner should only contain the members button in the top-right corner, and the home button on the search page needs stronger contrast. Rounded corners were recommended for category and dropdown elements for visual consistency.

Several page-specific revisions were suggested. On listing-related pages, heart/favorite icons should use a more visually consistent design, and visually favoriting an item is sufficient feedback for the user. The create listing page should be centered with improved padding, image upload placement should not appear at the bottom of the form, and multiple image previews should be supported without images dominating the layout.

Inbox and messaging flow also received feedback. Users should not automatically redirect to chat after sending a message from a listing page, but conversations should automatically select when entering the inbox. Loading states should be improved using React Suspense because the account page sometimes fails to detect the user during the first render.

The transaction completion page should visually indicate whether the buyer or seller has completed their confirmation using a checkmark or green circle indicator. Additionally, the team member page does not need the full navbar or dashboard navigation.

Mobile responsiveness also needs revision. Category layouts break on smaller screens and consume too much space, although implementing a hamburger menu is optional. The color scheme was positively received overall and considered consistent.

Summary of feedback on code and architecture

The instructor noted that the overall application structure is solid and the search functionality works correctly during testing. However, there are several architectural concerns to address. The .env file was accidentally committed to the

repository, which poses a security risk and should be removed from version control immediately.

Another major concern is backend startup reliability. If the database connection fails, the server still starts and silently fails on incoming requests. The instructor recommended implementing a fast-fail startup strategy so the server does not continue running when database connectivity is unavailable.

Additional frontend architecture feedback included improving loading behavior with React Suspense and reducing layout fragility where changing element heights currently breaks panel layouts.

Summary of feedback on GitHub usage

The GitHub workflow feedback focused on repository organization and commit hygiene. Branch naming should follow a more consistent convention such as prefixes indicating a feature or a fix. There are also many remote branches that have been merged, delete them to reduce clutter.

Commit messages also need improvement because several commits use vague or duplicate descriptions. While the current commit counts were considered acceptable, the instructor expects stronger collaboration and a more even distribution of contributions as the project approaches demo day.

Summary of feedback on DB

The database itself was reported as functional and accessible during review, and SSH/database access were both confirmed to work correctly.

However, there were concerns regarding backend/database interaction reliability. Specifically, the server currently continues running even when the database connection fails, causing silent failures during requests. The instructor recommended implementing proper startup validation and preventing the application from launching unless the database connection succeeds.

Summary of feedback on teamwork and risk management

The instructor reviewed contribution distribution using commit counts and noted that participation levels are acceptable for now, though collaboration expectations will increase as the team approaches demo day.

Risk management concerns mainly focused on repository maintenance and operational stability. Risks identified include:

- accidental exposure of sensitive .env files,
- excessive stale Git branches,

- inconsistent commit practices,
- and the backend's failure to stop when the database is unavailable.

Architecture Review:

- App structure is fine, Github branches need to be cleaned up and commit messages should be more detailed. Commit counts okay for now but can be improved on.

P1 Features:

Priority 1:

- Unregistered User
  - The system shall allow visitors to access the marketplace homepage.
  - The system shall allow visitors to browse publicly available item listings.
  - The system shall allow visitors to search listings using keywords.
  - The system shall allow visitors to view item details including title, description, price, and images.
  - The system shall allow visitors to filter listings by category.
- Registered User
  - The system shall allow users to register using an SFSU email address.
  - The system shall allow users to receive notifications when they receive messages.
  - The system shall verify that registered users are associated with an SFSU email domain.
- Seller
  - The system shall allow registered users to create listings for items they wish to sell.
  - The system shall allow users to upload images when creating listings.
  - The system shall allow users to mark listings as sold.
  - The system shall allow users to delete their listings.
- Buyer
  - The system shall allow users to initiate the sending of messages to other users
  - regarding listings.
- Admin
  - The system shall allow administrators to remove listings that violate policies.
  - The system shall allow administrators to monitor marketplace activity.